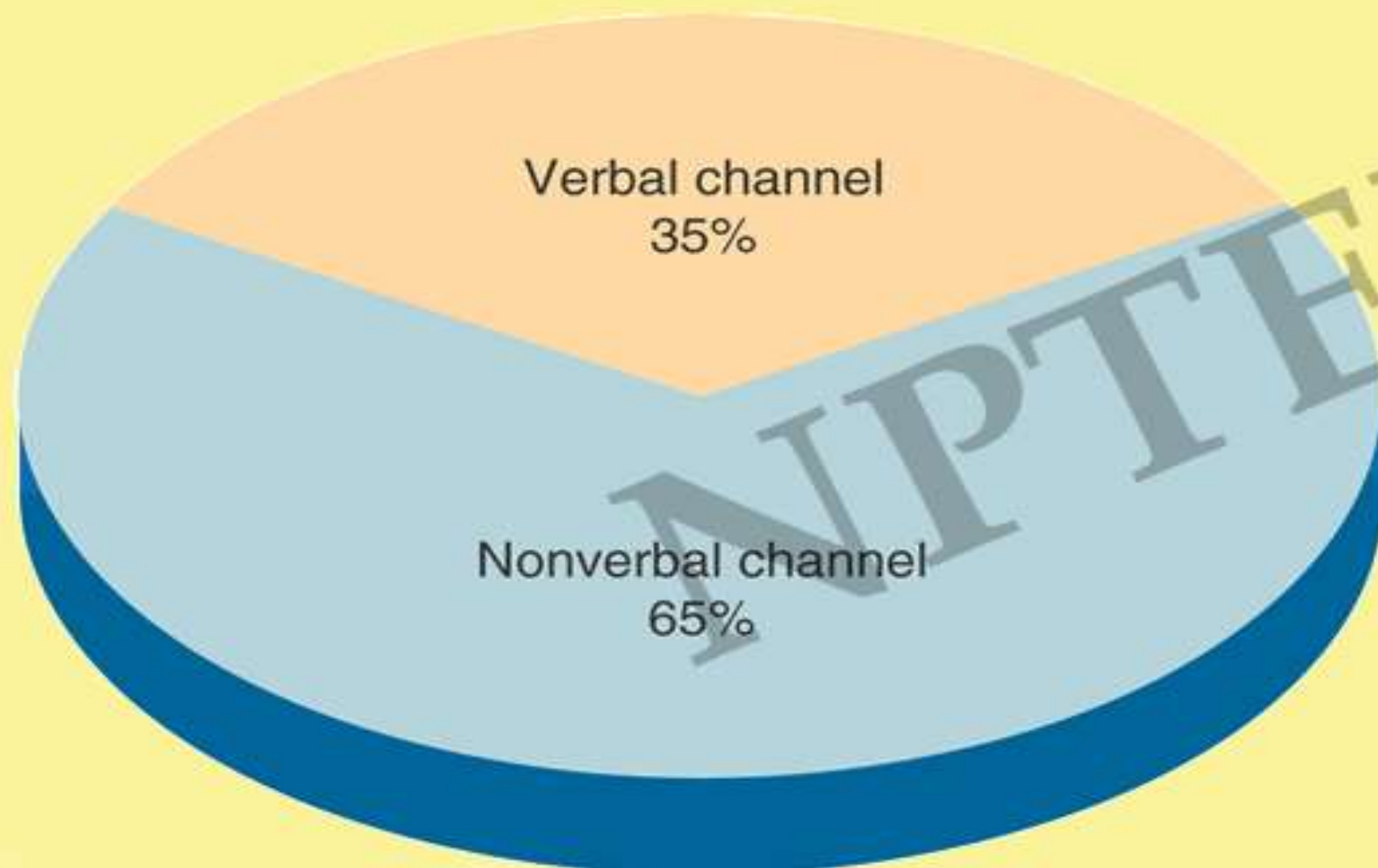


Communicating without words

(Contd.)

- Communication researcher Mehrabian found that only 7% of a message's effect are carried by words; listeners receive the other 93% through non-verbal means.
- Birdwhistell suggested that spoken words account for not more than 30-35% of all our social interactions.
- Almost 65 percent of the social meaning of the messages we send to others are communicated non-verbally.

Communication of social meaning



Functions of Nonverbal Communication

- Message reinforcement or Complementation
- Message negation
- Message substitution
- Message accentuation or intensification
- Message regulation

Aspects of Nonverbal Communication

Nonverbal message categories:

1. Body language or Kinesics
2. Clothing and Artifactual communication
3. Voice or Paralanguage
4. Space and distance, or Proxemic factors
5. Color
6. Time, or Chronemics
7. Touch, or Haptics
8. Smell, or Olfactics

1. Body Language: Kinesics

- Kinesics—study of human body motion or body language
- Facial expressions

(contd.)

- Facial management techniques—means we use to control the expressions we reveal to others

- Eyebrows and forehead
- Civil inattention—polite ignoring of others so as not to infringe on their privacy

NP

2. Clothing and artifacts

- Artifactual Communication—use of personal adornments
- Artifactual communication, is an integral part of the nonverbal package.

(contd.)

- It includes the use of personal adornments such as clothing, jewellery, makeup, hairstyles, and beards.
- People are apt to make inferences about us based on the way we dress.

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3. Voice: Paralanguage

- Paralanguage—vocal cues that accompany spoken language
- Pitch—highness or lowness of the voice
- Habitual pitch—characteristic pitch one uses
- Volume—degree of loudness
- Rate—speaking speed
- Non-fluencies—meaningless sounds or phrases which disrupt the flow of speech
- Silence—absence of paralinguistic and verbal cues

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4. Space and distance: Proxemic and environmental Factors (contd.)

- Proxemics—the study of the use of space

Proxemic cues, including the treatment of space and territory influence interaction and help define the communication experience.

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Proxemics

- Distances—Intimate, Personal, Social, and Public (contd.)

- Edward Hall says there are four different distances that we keep between ourselves and other people:

Intimate distance - 0 to 18 inches;

Personal distance - 18 inches to 4 feet;

Social distance - 4 to 12 feet; and

Public distance - 12 feet to the limit of sight

Based on the perceived permanence of the physical Space, Researchers divide environmental Spaces into three categories: Informal, Semi-fixed-feature, and Fixed feature

- Informal space —highly mobile and can be quickly changed
- Semi-fixed-feature space —the use of objects to create distance
- Fixed-feature space —contains relatively permanent objects

Aspects of Nonverbal Communication

5. Colors: Meanings and associations

6. Time: Communicative value of Chronemics

- Chronemics—study of time use

7. Touch: Haptics

- Haptics—study of the use of touch

8. Smell: Olfactics

- Olfactics- study of the use of smell

NP

Gender and Nonverbal behavior:

Masculine and Feminine styles

- The ways men and women use nonverbal cues reflects societal practices.
- Visual dominance—measure calculated by comparing the percentage of looking while speaking with the percentage of looking while listening

Maximizing Nonverbal Communication Skills

- Smile genuinely
- Be aware of false cues
- Keep appropriate distance
- Use touch carefully
- Respect status
- Shake hands appropriately

Part II: Cross-Cultural Communication

Why is communicating across cultures important today?

- Technological advances have made workplaces more global
- Understanding those who buy and use a company's products or services helps you design ones that fit your customers' needs
- Successful communication improves productivity and creates a comfortable workplace
- Communicating with those from other cultures enriches your business and personal life

Some Gesture differences

Gesture	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
Hand up, palm out, wrist stiff, back and forth motion	Good-bye (America)	No (Europe)
Raised hand with index finger extended, head high	Come here (America)	Rude to point a finger (Japan)
Raised hand, fingers in "V" position	Victory or peace (with palm out) (America)	Double, sexual, insulting (with palm in) (England)
Thumbs up	Fine, Good going, Everything is okay (America)	Strong, sexual, insulting (Nigeria and Australia)
Vertical horns	Hook 'em Horns (Texas)	Your spouse is unfaithful (Italy) Good luck (Brazil and Venezuela)

Substitutes for Two-word Verbs

Two-word Verb

cut up

keyed up

live down

put away

shut out

tie down

track down

Substitute

clown

excited, nervous

remove, overcome

kill

prevent

hold

search

NPT

Some American Idioms to avoid

- cold turkey
- egg on
- goldfish bowl
- in a nutshell
- snow job
- stick in the mud
- through thick and thin
- tie the knot
- up a tree
- walk on air
- wheel and deal
- wolf in sheep's clothing

NPTE

3. Suggestions for Communicating across Cultures successfully

- Talk or write as simply and clearly as possible
- Word questions carefully
 1. Avoid double questions
 2. Avoid yes/no questions
 3. Avoid negative questions
- Use continuous confirmation
 1. Use back translating when possible
 2. Use technology to assist with written and oral communication

NP

Preparing to communicate across Cultures

- Effective communication and the ability to understand cultural differences that are too frequently deficient both in students and in educators
- Assess your ability to communicate effectively with persons from different cultures.
- Ours is an age of increased global contact and diversity. Consequently, assessing and developing an understanding of and sensitivity to cultural differences is an essential component in each of our communication repertoires.
- To the extent we are able to reduce cultural ignorance and enhance cultural awareness, we increase our personal preparedness to communicate effectively

The cost of Cultural ignorance

- Diversity— the recognition and valuing of difference
- Multiculturalists— persons respectful of and engaged with people from distinctly different cultures
- Culturally confused—lack of understanding of cultural difference
- Cultural imperialism—expansion of dominion of one culture over another culture
- By taking steps to eliminate cultural misunderstandings, we also facilitate the development of more meaningful relationships between persons from different cultures whether these relationships occur face-to-face or online

Defining Intercultural Communication

1. Inter-cultural communication—interacting with individuals from different cultures
2. Inter-racial communication—interpreting and sharing meanings with individuals from different races
3. Inter-ethnic communication—interacting with individuals of different ethnic origins
4. Inter-national communication—communication between persons representing different nations
5. Intra-cultural communication – interaction with members of the same racial or ethnic group or co-culture as yours

NP

Defining Intercultural Communication (cont.)

Cultures and Co-Cultures

- Marginalized group—a group whose members feel like outsiders
- Assimilation – the means by which co-culture members attempt to fit in

with members of the dominant culture

- Accommodation—strategy of co-culture members who attempt to maintain

their cultural identity even while they strive to establish relationships with

members of the dominant culture

- Separation – the means co-culture members use to resist interaction with members of the dominant culture

Defining Intercultural Communication (cont.)

Culture guides Communication

- Ethnocentrism—tendency to see one's own culture as superior to all others
- Cultural relativism—acceptance of other cultural groups as equal in value to one's own

The Intercultural Communication imperative:

Reduce the strangeness of strangers

Exploring Cultural differences

- Individualism versus Collectivism
 1. Individualistic cultures—cultures in which individual goals are stressed
 2. Collectivistic cultures—culture in which group goals are stressed

Exploring Cultural differences

- High context versus Low context

1. High-context communication—tradition-bound communication system

that depends on indirectness

2. Low-context communication—system that encourages directness in communication

The Intercultural Communication imperative: Reduce the strangeness of strangers (cont.)

Exploring Cultural differences

- High power distance versus Low power distance

1. High power distance cultures—cultures based on power differences in which subordinates defer to superiors

2. Low power distance cultures—culture that believes that power should be used when legitimate

Exploring Cultural differences

- Masculine versus Feminine Cultures

1. Masculine cultures—members value male aggressiveness, strength, and material symbols of success

2. Feminine cultures—members value relationships, tenderness in members of both sexes and ensuring a high quality of life

The Intercultural Communication imperative: Reduce the strangeness of strangers (cont.)

- Stereotypes – mental images; shortcuts that guide reactions
- Prejudices – a positive or negative prejudgement

Technology and Intercultural Communication

Virtual neighborhoods or communities—online, surrogate communities

- Digital divide – information gap